him because they did not know he had changed his car.

The lieutenant colonel is well known in town because he helped broker a ceasefire agreement between the RCSS/SSA-S and the central government. Before signing the agreement in 2011, the RCSS/SSA-S was one of the major ethnic armed groups in the country (Keenan 2012). In April 1988 the officer was a summer school teacher in Taunggyi and only planned to stay there until the end of classes. However, he was caught up in the student protests and arrested, according to him, simply because he was in the wrong place at the wrong time. He was released after three months in prison. While there he began to understand the struggles of the ethnic minorities and was sympathetic to them. After his release, he joined the SSA together with five other teachers who had been arrested at the same time. He fought in the jungles and eventually rose to the rank of lieutenant colonel. In 2005 he was seriously ill, so he left the SSA and went to China for treatment. He returned to Taunggyi after he recovered. In 2010 when the RCSS/SSA-S began ceasefire talks with the government, his former superior called him to lead the negotiation team, probably because he was the most educated person they could trust. In barely three years, the lieutenant colonel had undergone a dramatic identity transformation, from being an enemy of the state to becoming a landowner and developer.

The story of the lieutenant colonel is not unique in Myanmar. Many of the country's wealthy elite were drug lords or enemies of the state before they became successful entrepreneurs. The country's largest conglomerate, Asia World, was formed by the 'godfather of heroin' Lo Hsing Han. Likewise, Nay Win Tun, a former general of the Pa-O National Army (PNA), owns the Ruby Dragon group of companies, which operates lucrative jade mines in Kachin State. These former enemies of the state were co-opted with economic incentives.

The RCSS/SSA-S signing the ceasefire agreement and the lieutenant colonel's increase in fortune constitute a form of ceasefire capitalism — a term coined by Kevin Woods (2011) to describe the production of capital that relies on a specially constructed political economy conducive to state control. While this specially formed political economy is itself a subject of interest, how a ceasefire agreement translates into furthering state control requires clarification.

Moreover, the story of the lieutenant colonel is interesting on two counts. First, it appears the ceasefire dividends not only benefited the top brass, but also trickled down to lower levels of the armed opposition. This